



Product Requirements Document: Improving Text Reviews Mechanism for Zomato.

Team: Ratings & Reviews (Food Delivery Vertical)

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Status: In Development

Problem Definition

Majority of Zomato customers feel the current process to write a review on the platform needs too much effort and they feel lazy in doing so without gaining any value out of it like incentives or future discount offers. Solving this problem is essential for Zomato to increase its Customer Lifetime Value and platform credibility in a highly competitive and growing food delivery market in India.

What is the problem?

Customers are often not writing text reviews because they find the process of writing a review too time consuming and not worth their effort without getting any value out of it. This leads to increased risk to platform credibility and hurdles in gaining customer trust.

Who is facing the problem?

Users of the age group 16-24 who order from Zomato at least twice / week. Around 52% of these consider reviews to be extremely important in helping them make their food ordering decision.

What is the value that will be unlocked by solving the problem?

- **For Business:** Increased customer lifetime value due to more customer satisfaction, increased online visibility due to more user uploaded content, increased platform credibility.
- **For Users:** Better decision making -> increased satisfaction, helps in discovering better food -> better overall experience, increased benefits if some value is offered in return of reviewing.

Why is it urgent to solve this problem NOW?

- **Competitive Advantage:** Increasing the number of reviews on the platform will help build customer trust fast and retain the already existing customers, reducing customer churn to the competition and gain competitive edge by building platform credibility in a highly competitive market.
- **Building a User Driven Platform:** More reviews will help make the platform more user driven -> Zomato stands out among all the competitors and thus enhance customer experience & reduce market threat.

Goals

- Increase the number of text reviews on Zomato food delivery vertical. [\(KPI Tree\)](#)
- Increase the % of target customers writing reviews by 6% by the end of two subsequent quarters.
- Enhance customer satisfaction, engagement and retention on the platform.

- Increase customer lifetime value and platform credibility to maintain & expand the market share.
- Reduce user effort in posting a text review.

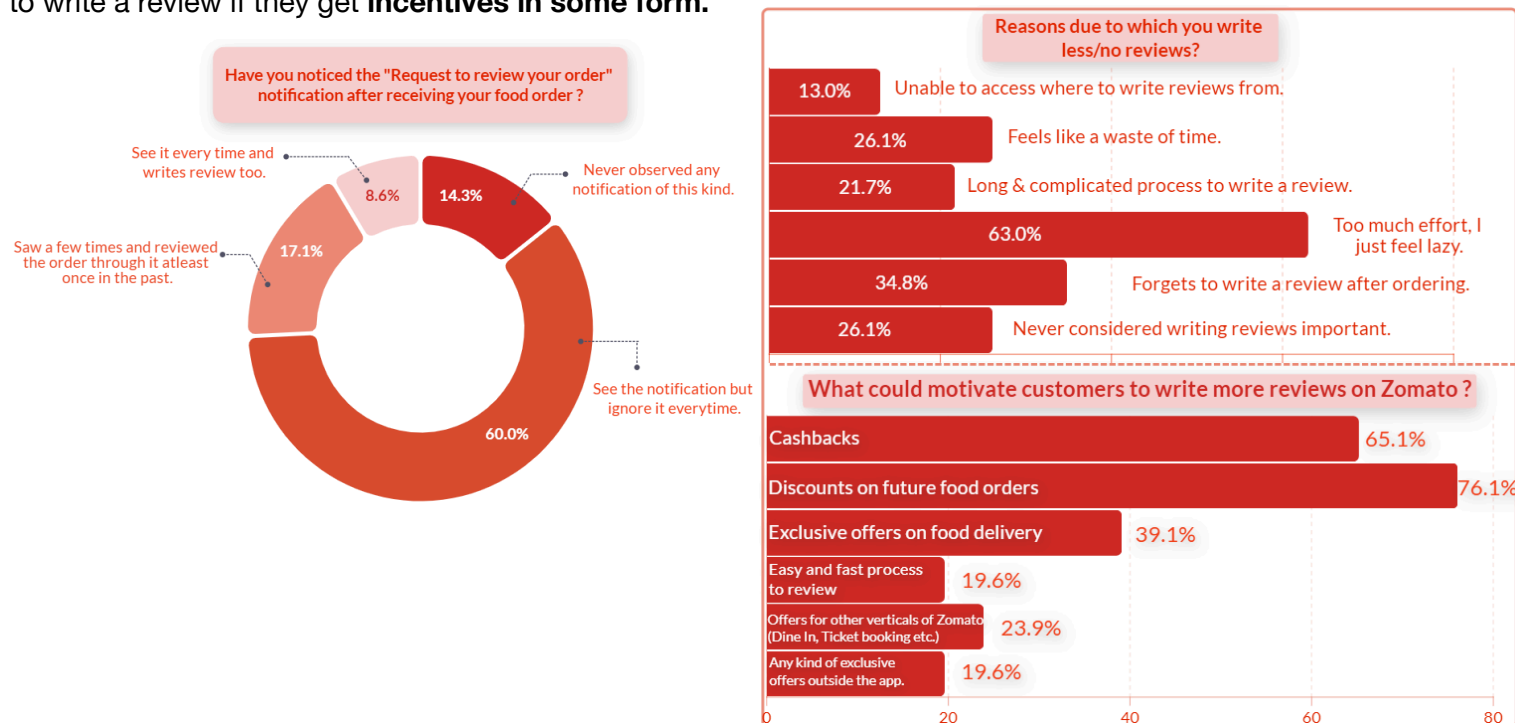
Non-Goals

The scope does not include:

- Acquiring new customers to increase the # of reviews.
- Increasing the number of orders to increase the # of reviews.
- Any function of the app outside of the ratings & reviews page/scope.

Validation of the Problem

User research data shows that around **63%** of the **customers** feel that **writing reviews is too much effort** and they feel too lazy doing so, **26.1%** consider it as a **waste of time** & **76.1%** say they would feel motivated to write a review if they get **incentives in some form**.



Understanding the Target Audience

Customers who on an average order food **at least 2+ times per week**. This segment makes approximately **30%** of total Zomato customers. Out of 18M monthly active users (MAU) on the platform, **5M** fall under the target segment to be focused on.

Key User Personas:

Name	Demographics	Goals	Pain Points
Avni	<i>Occupation:</i> College Student, lives in a hostel. <i>Age:</i> 19 <i>Gender:</i> Female <i>Personality Traits:</i> Tech-savvy, Quick learner, Hard Working	- Wants better quality food than what's served in hostel mess. - Wants quick food delivery when rushing for classes / in-between lectures - Wants variety in food depending on her mood.	- Review writing process feels too much effort & waste of time - Unable to judge food quality of restaurants with less reviews - No incentives offered for writing reviews.
Avinash	<i>Occupation:</i> Product Manager <i>Age:</i> 23 <i>Gender:</i> Male <i>Personality Traits:</i> Critical thinker, Gym goer, Tech-savvy	- Wants healthy protein rich food options. - Ordering food quickly when in office. - Wants a change from regular meals cooked at home.	- Often forgets to write a review after receiving an order. - Difficulty locating the review button on the restaurant page. - Some restaurants have less reviews → difficult to trust.

Solution

Mind Mapping:

[\(Solution Mind Mapping\)](#)



Solution:

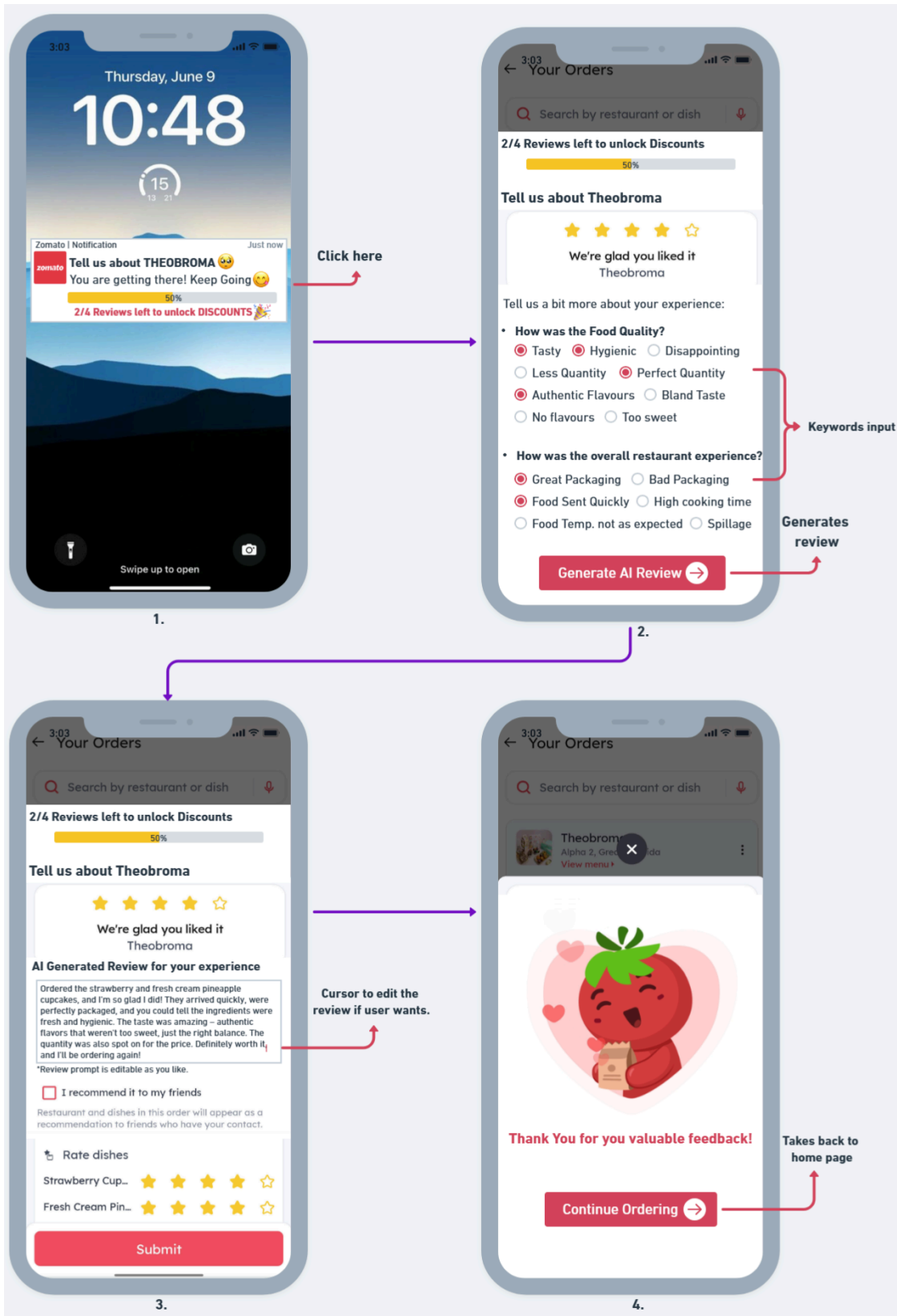
Core Description: Customer journey to write a review will be made quicker & easier by adding 3-4 multiple keyword selection questions about different parts of the food delivery and quality, based on the selected keyword options, AI generated text review draft will be made and shown to the customer. Based on this draft, the customer might choose to post it as it is or make a few edits in it if they like to & then post it.

Other features:

- Users will be offered a “Top Explorer” badge for that month upon writing 4 or more reviews/month to validate their food exploration & contribution to help other customers reading those reviews.
- All “Top Explorers” will be offered discounts on future orders based on the # of reviews they write per month.
- The notification prompt will be having a progress bar showing the customer their progress towards being a “Top Explorer”.

Wireframes:

(Wireframes)



Key Metrics

Functional Metrics

North Star Metric	• Total # of text reviews written / month
OMTM	• # Text reviews posted per month after generating through AI.
Acquisition	• # Customers using AI generation to generate at least 1 review. (Acquired Customers) • % Total Customers acquired.
Activation	• # Customers posting at least 1 AI generated review. (Activated Customers) • % Acquired customers posting the review. • % Target segment writing at least 1 review / month.
Engagement	• Avg. # orders reviewed by AI generation / customer. • % orders reviewed by AI generation / customer. • Avg. # text reviews / restaurant posted by AI generation. • Avg. # AI review prompts generated / customer. • Avg. # keywords selected / customer to generate AI review.
Customer Satisfaction	• NPS score for AI review generation feature.

Non-Functional Metrics

- Review page response time.
- AI review generation time after submitting the keywords.
- System Downtime probability
- Total system uptime
- Failure rate while submitting review.

Why are these metrics important?

These metrics are important to continuously assess the effectiveness of the solution implemented to tackle the problem and identify areas of improvement and user response to the executed solution, functional metrics are focused on the results analysis post implementation of the solution, whereas non-functional metrics are important to assess the technical capabilities and quality of the platform.

Launch Readiness

- **Key Milestones:** Identifying Business Goals → Mapping to product outcomes leading to that goal → User Research → Identifying & defining the problem → Formulating & validating Hypothesis → Brainstorming solutions → Designing → Development → QA → Dogfooding → Make amends based on testing results → Launch the feature.
- **Launch Checklist:**

1. **Senior Management:** Proposing the solution to the senior management & explaining the value generated from it, seeking approvals & making sure everyone is on the same page.
2. **UI/UX Design:** Explaining the design to the designers and exploring the feasibility & possible alternatives.
3. **Engineering:** Getting the developers to understand the solution & its functioning, feasibility & roadmapping the tech implementation.
4. **QA & Operations:** Solution testing & reiterating based on test results to optimize for better user experience and company constraints before launch.

Go-To-Market Strategy

Pre-Launch

- **Intriguing notifications** like “What if you could save money by ordering food more?” To generate curiosity about the upcoming feature among the target user segment, tapping the notification takes the user on a description page where they can try generating a demo review to understand the feature.
- **Running interactive ads** on social media pages, showing perks & demos of the feature usage along with the chef & delivery partner’s struggles to fulfill their order and hoping for a good review post that.

Post-Launch

- “Get discounts on your future orders with the help of AI” or similar prompt on opening the app, which when selected takes the customer to their most recent order and makes them generate their first AI review through an interactive tutorial.
- Social media ads on Instagram, Facebook, and Snapchat feature an interactive demo box where users select keywords to generate an AI review. Post generation, clicking the “Try Now” button takes them to their Zomato order history to post a real AI review.
- Re-iterating the discounts & offers for regular reviewers as per criteria mentioned in the solution above & tracking post launch metrics implementing continuous feedback-improvement mechanism.

Future Iterations

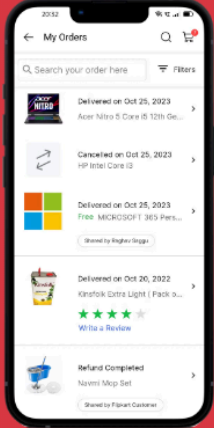
- Expanding the target user segment to customers ordering on an **avg. at least once / month**.
- Integrating **voice prompt input** to generate an editable review draft with the help of AI based on the voice prompt input.
- Better placement of the write a review for past orders button inside the app for better visibility.
- Multi-lingual review writing, allowing users to write reviews in their regional language depending on the restaurant location. (Reviews for restaurants in Gujarat can be written in Gujarati and so on.)

Appendix

Competitive Analysis

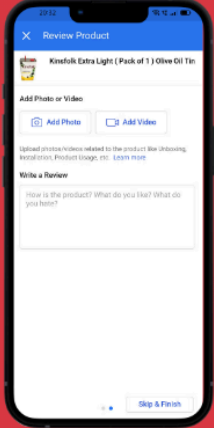
Online Reviews Analysis of Flipkart & Tripadvisor:

• Flipkart:



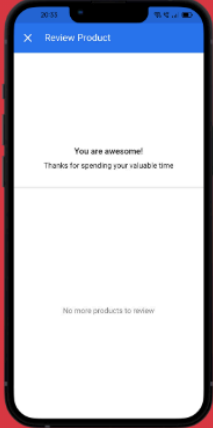
1.

Navigate to the product & drop a star rating in one tap.



2.

Simple and easy to write review page, with an option to attach media along with the text review.

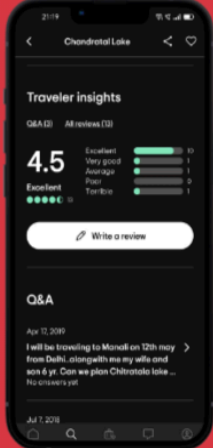


3.

Easy review submission, no popups / request to review other products user ordered.

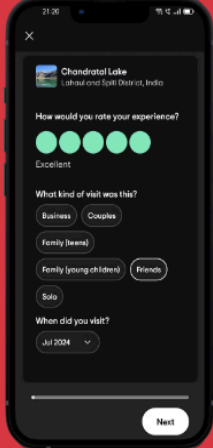
Pros	Cons
• Posting Fake/Spam reviews not possible. • Media (Photos/Videos) can be attached with reviews for more authenticity. • Verified reviews & easy-to-use UI for people who are not too tech-savvy. • Location of the reviewer mentioned alongside the review. • Short review highlights mentioned with each review	• Difficult to find the reviewing button and no option to review for shared orders. • Missed opportunity to ask the user to review their other orders as well, after submitting a review. • People who have used the product but have not bought it from Flipkart can't drop a review.

• Tripadvisor:



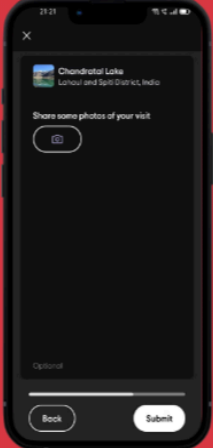
1.

QnAs included to be answered by the users alongside the reviews button.



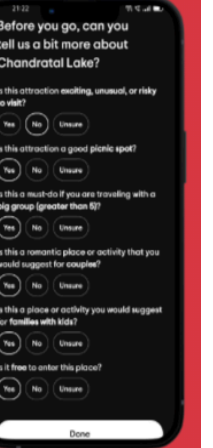
2.

Purpose of visit and timeline tiles integrated to avoid any misjudgement due to timeline mismatch.



3.

Option to add photos along with text reviews. No option to attach videos.



4.

Apart from text reviews by the user, MCQs are integrated to gain more insights from the reviewer.

Pros	Cons
• Easy MCQ questions included, gaining more insights along with the text review from the reviewer. • Any user can review any location, and answer QnAs increasing the amount of user-uploaded material on the platform, resulting in better SEO. • AI generated reviews summary quick to read.	• User can't leave a review shorter than 100 characters. • No option to just leave rating without dropping a text review. • No option to attach a video along with the review. • Prone to fake/spam reviews as anyone can drop a review without any verification.

User Survey

A [survey](#) was conducted among customers fulfilling the

target

Who are they?

- 81% are Gen-Z and Millennials.
- 80% are from Tier 1 cities.
- 59% & 39% are students and working professionals respectively.
- 53% Males & 47% Females.

Which is their go-to food ordering app?

- 76% Zomato - 24% Swiggy

What does the target segment feel about reviews on the app?

- 50% consider reviews extremely important to make their food ordering decision.
- 30% don't know where to access the text review section on the restaurant page to read reviews.
- 36% saw the "Review your order" notification in the past but always ignored it & 21% don't remember seeing such a notification ever.

What does the target segment feel about writing a review for their orders?

- 40% have never written a review & 36% write sometimes.
- 63% feel too lazy to write a review & consider that it requires too much effort that's not worth it.

What could motivate the target customers to write more reviews?

- 76% feel they would write a review if they get discounts on future orders.
- 66% feel cashbacks can provide them value enough for them to write reviews.

Impact Estimates

Target Segment size = 5 M users. [\(Calculation\)](#)

Assumptions:

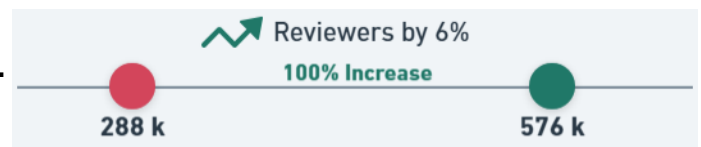
- % target customers currently writing reviews = **6%**
- % orders getting reviewed per target segment reviewer = **10%**

No. of Reviews = # reviewers * avg # of orders/reviewer per month * % of orders reviewed per reviewer.

- # Reviews by target customers = **288 k/month.**

If % of target segment writing reviews grow from 6% to 12% [\(Calculation\)](#)

- # Reviews posted by target segment = **576 k/month.**



Solution Selection

To solve this problem, we had to make sure customers do not feel that the process of writing a review is too much effort, and ensure that they get some value in return for their effort. Proposed solutions for solving these problems were:

1. Top Contributor Club:

Creating a community of top reviewers, by providing them the “Top Contributor” badge upon writing total 30+ reviews over time, after which they would be able to claim discounts and offers on future orders on Zomato, if they maintain 4+ reviews per month post completing a total of 30 reviews in lifetime.

2. AI Review Generation:

Customer journey to write a review will be made quicker & easier by adding 3-4 multiple keyword selection questions about different parts of the food delivery and quality, based on the selected keyword options, AI generated text review draft will be made and shown to the customer. Based on this draft, the customer might choose to post it as it is or make a few edits in it if they like to & then post it. Users will be offered a “Top Explorer” badge for that month upon writing 4 or more reviews/month to validate their food exploration & contribution to help other customers reading those reviews. All “Top Explorers” will be offered discounts on future orders based on the # of reviews they write per month. The notification prompt will be having a progress bar showing the customer their progress towards being a “Top Explorer”.

3. Ready made review templates in app:

Offering ready made review templates based on the star rating given by the customer. A 4-5 star rating would get a ready-made positive review auto-filled in the review field, ready to be edited and posted by the reviewer according to the experience. Similarly 3 star would get a seemingly neutral template and 1-2 star would get a critique template with fields to be filled which need improvement.

Prioritization

Prioritized solutions based on Reach, Impact, Confidence, Effort (RICE) score.

RICE Score Calculation: $(\text{Reach} \times \text{Impact} \times \text{Confidence}) / (\text{Effort})$

(all from a scale of 1-10)

[\(Prioritization\)](#)

Solution	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score
Top Contributor Club	10	6	6	4	90
AI Review Generation	10	10	10	7	142 ★ → Prioritized
In-Built review templates	10	8	9	7	102